Sunset at the Wrong Time

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 1

The garden keeper opened the illustrated maintenance guide beside a chime that rang at the wrong point in the garden's cycle. Nib listened carefully and proposed a larger bell. Lark watched the moving wheel instead. A louder wrong-time chime would still ring at the wrong time.

“A louder noon,” Nib suggested hopefully. “A better explanation,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **boat**

“A longer word can contain two familiar closed chunks,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read sun, then set. Join sun-set into sunset, then think about the whole meaning. Breaking a word helps us read it; joining it again helps us understand it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sunset. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read sunset on the guide's cycle picture,” Lark invited gently. “Does that picture match the moment when we heard the chime?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sun is up. The bell did not ring at sunset.**

“Does the passage say the bell rang at sunset?” Lark asked gently. “Which word changes that claim?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark recorded the observed mismatch without naming a cause. Nib drew the wheel mark where it had actually been, not where he expected it. The keeper agreed to another look the next morning. For today they had a useful question and an honest first note, rather than a louder bell.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write sunset beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first garden journal page kept observation separate from explanation. Before inspecting the mechanism, the crew would need a dry, steady place to open its heavy guide.

Go to the Little Shelter

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 2

Morning showed two shelters. Nib chose the tiny roof behind a root because it looked cozy. The work table would not fit beneath it. Lark measured its footprint against the clear shelter beside the working path. The useful place was not the smallest or the prettiest.

“A cozy little shelter,” Nib declared. “A table-sized shelter,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sunset**

“A syllable ending in a vowel can have a long vowel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to me with long e, go with long o, and hi with long i. Robot begins with long ro, and unit begins with /yoo/. Baby begins with long ba; its final y says long e, unlike y in my. Read those modeled chunks and rejoin each word. These examples are useful, with exceptions still possible.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try me, go, hi, robot, baby, unit. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read go in the supplied route note,” Lark invited gently. “Which shelter leaves room for the actual table?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Go to the shelter. The baby can nap.**

“Where does the first sentence send us?” Lark asked gently. “Does the second sentence give another direction or tell what someone can do?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib carried the light kit to the clear shelter. The keeper brought the table, and the closed guide rested fully on top. The crew could work beside the path without blocking it. The smaller roof remained a perfectly pleasant place for something smaller than a work station.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write go beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the real table footprint in your journal. The guide was dry inside the chosen shelter. Its cover showed beautiful plants, but the next useful page would be the one about the working mechanism.

The Theme on the Cover

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 3

Nib admired the planting pictures on the guide's cover. He opened a page of flowers while the wheel waited outside. Lark checked the operating-section tab. The picture was interesting, but it did not describe the mechanism whose timing needed investigation.

“These are splendid flowers,” Nib exclaimed. “This is the wheel’s section,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

me

“We can reuse silent-e chunks in a longer word like inside,” Lark explained clearly. “Theme and these add a rarer e-and-final-e spelling for long e. Listen to those whole examples before reading them. We don't ask their familiar-looking letters to teach an unmodeled pattern by themselves.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inside, theme, these. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read these on the prepared tab strip,” Lark invited gently. “Then follow the supplied operating-section heading to the wheel diagram.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **These notes tell the theme. The theme is the wheel.**

“What topic do the notes concern?” Lark asked gently. “Look at the sentence with theme.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The correct section opened to a drawing of the shaded inlet. The keeper pointed out the access route and asked the crew to inspect it at the next visit. Nib slipped a marker into that page. The flowers remained in the guide for another purpose; their beauty had not made them an explanation of the fault.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write theme beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded which section mattered and why. The heavy guide stayed closed in the dry shelter overnight. Next morning, a lamp would help the crew see the inlet without changing it.

A Light for the Night Note

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 4

A deep shadow crossed the inlet. Nib called it a very solid blockage. Lark stood where the guide showed the channel, but the dark patch hid its surface. Before deciding what stopped the water, they needed a better view of what was actually there.

“A very solid shadow,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A shadow we can look behind,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inside**

“Igh writes long i in light and night,” Lark modeled clearly. “Keep the three-letter team together. Moonlight joins moon and light into one compound. Read the parts, rejoin them, and check that the whole word fits what it describes.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try night, light, moonlight. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read light on the inspection card,” Lark invited gently. “Where can the supported lamp illuminate the inlet without moving its water or cover?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The light is on. I can see the inlet.**

“What does the light help the speaker see?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say the light repairs anything?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib set the lamp on a broad dry ledge. Light reached behind the shadow. Some water passed through, but less than the guide's ordinary-flow picture showed. The shadow had been a viewing problem, not proof of a blockage. The crew kept the low-flow observation and prepared to inspect the bank more closely.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write light beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the new observation beneath the first question. The lamp stayed on its real ledge. A keeper's older work record identified the corner where the inlet access cover could be reached.

The Farmer's Corner

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 5

Two corners looked alike from the shelter. Nib inspected both and reported that each was thoroughly corner-shaped. Lark brought the keeper's old work record. Its description placed the access cover beside the inlet, rather than beside the planting bed on the opposite side.

“Every corner has a corner,” Nib observed. “This record names one,” Lark replied with patient amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **night**

“Longer words can hold familiar r-controlled chunks,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read farm-er and cor-ner, then join farmer and corner smoothly. Shelter has familiar parts too. A name or heading with an untaught spelling can still be supplied without replacing our decoding.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try farmer, corner, shelter. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read corner on the prepared record,” Lark invited gently. “Which location matches the inlet in the diagram?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The farmer is by the corner. The shelter is dry.**

“Where is the farmer?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about the shelter instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib followed the fixed path to the correct corner. Beneath a layer of loose leaves, the old access cover was visible and reachable. They left it closed while checking the next inspection step. Back in the shelter, the table rocked when the heavy guide opened. That support needed fixing before they worked from its pages.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write corner beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the access corner in your journal. It was found without moving every cover in the garden. The crew returned to the table's loose foot before bringing more heavy pages to its top.

The Table with the Little Ending

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 6

The heavy guide tipped one corner of the work table. Nib held up a tall bottle as a possible support. Lark pointed to the table's own loose foot fitting. Adding a fragile tower would leave the actual fault untouched.

“A bottle would add height,” Nib argued hopefully. “The foot would add steadiness,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **farmer**

“At the end of table, consonant-le makes an unstressed chunk,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to table, candle, and bottle. Join the chunks into their ordinary spoken words rather than reciting separate letter names or making every vowel equally strong.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try table, candle, bottle. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read table on the support note,” Lark invited gently. “Which fitting belongs to its own foot?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bottle is on the table. A candle is by it.**

“Where is the bottle?” Lark asked gently. “Which object does it refer to in the other sentence?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper supported the table while Nib tightened the foot. The guide opened without rocking. The bottle stayed on a shelf, where it did not have to hold a work station upright. Now the crew could compare the water-bed drawing and its actual low measuring notch.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write table beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed a table supported by its own foot. Beyond the shelter, a tall marker stood beside the low water-line notch, giving the next reading two very different heights to consider.

The Tall Marker

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 7

Nib recorded the top of the tall marker as the water level. It made the channel seem impressively full. Lark crouched beside the real water-line notch near its base. The label described a tall post; it did not say the water reached its top.

“A remarkably tall amount of water,” Nib announced. “A remarkably tall post,” Lark corrected kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **table**

“In all, tall, and ball, a has the vowel sound we are explicitly modeling here,” Lark explained clearly. “It isn't the short a of mat. Read the examples, then keep the word's meaning separate from the measurement we take beside the object.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try all, tall, ball. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tall on the comparison card,” Lark invited gently. “Which actual notch shows where the water reaches?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The post is tall. The notch is low.**

“Does tall describe the post or the notch?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes the notch?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib lowered his pencil to the observed water line. The reading was low, matching the earlier view of weak flow at the inlet. Lark crossed out the mistaken post-top measurement with a single line so the revision stayed visible. The access cover already found at the inlet was their next inspection point.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write tall beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal distinguished the marker's height from the water's level. The crew had a stronger question about the inlet, without pretending that one low reading already named its cause.

The Bank Beneath the Leaves

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 8

The keeper opened the inlet cover. Leaves lay pressed against a displaced screen. Nib fetched a brush large enough for the whole bank. Lark laid the guide beside the small screen and its collecting tray. The trouble occupied much less space than Nib's proposed sweeping route.

“The whole bank needs a brush,” Nib proposed. “This small screen needs room,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **all**

“In bank and sink, nk represents /ng/ followed closely by /k/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare ring, with its single ng sound, and bank, with the added ending. Read bank, sink, and pink without inserting a vowel inside that final group.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bank, sink, pink. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read bank on the access note,” Lark invited gently. “Which small part does its diagram actually ask the keeper to clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bank is wet. A leaf is on the screen.**

“Where is the leaf?” Lark asked gently. “Does the first sentence explain the clock timing?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper lifted the leaf mat into a collecting tray and reseated the screen. Nib carried the tray away from the channel. Flow visibly improved. Then the clock chimed at the wrong point again. Lark kept both results: the inlet repair helped water flow, and the timing problem still needed explaining.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write bank beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal marked the screen repair complete without marking the whole garden fixed. The keeper's work log held earlier completed tasks and a different page for what still needed checking.

What the Keeper Planted

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 9

Nib read the work log and prepared to clear the screen again. Lark showed him the check beside the completed job. Yesterday's work and tomorrow's questions were on different pages. Repeating everything would hide the useful fact that the inlet repair was already done.

“We could plant it all again,” Nib offered eagerly. “We can read what was already done,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bank**

“Ed can sound /t/, /d/, or /id/ in these examples,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to jumped, played, and planted. The same ending spelling marks completed actions, but its spoken sound changes. We'll read each whole word and connect it to what happened.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try jumped, played, planted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the completed-task entry,” Lark invited gently. “Which work should stay checked while we inspect the remaining linkage?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam planted. Pat played by the bank.**

“Who completed the planting?” Lark asked gently. “Which action belongs to Pat instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib left the repaired screen alone. Lark added the improved-flow observation to its finished entry, then opened the current linkage note. Outside, the water wheel turned while the chime arm waited in its catch. That difference was the new question, not a reason to undo the old repair.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write planted beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept completed work and remaining questions on separate lines. The wheel's motion could now be compared directly with the waiting arm, with no new leaves introduced to explain away the mismatch.

The Wheel Still Turning

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 10

Water turned the wheel. The chime arm rested in a catch. Nib watched both, then carefully reported that one moving part was moving while another was not. Lark welcomed the smaller, clearer observation. The mechanism could be understood one relationship at a time.

“It is all turning, except the bit that is not,” Nib reported carefully. “That difference matters,” Lark replied.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **jumped**

“Ing can describe an ongoing action in planting, jumping, and resting,” Lark modeled clearly. “Here the base stays visible before ing. Compare planted with planting. Later words may need spelling changes; today we use examples whose base stays intact.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try planting, jumping, resting. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the ongoing and completed descriptions,” Lark invited gently. “Which one matches the wheel now, and which matches yesterday's screen work?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The wheel is turning. The arm is resting.**

“Which part is resting?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say every part has stopped?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The comparison separated current motion from finished repair. Lark followed the guide's linkage line from the waiting arm to a small reset lever. The arm was being held, not waiting for the water to begin. They left the flowing channel alone and prepared to inspect that helper control with the keeper.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write resting beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed two simultaneous states. Nib traced the linkage on paper rather than poking at the mechanism. The next test would use the lever that actually did the reset job.

The Helper Lever

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 11

Two levers had similar handles. Nib reached for the bigger one, which looked impressively helpful. The guide's small connecting line led to the other lever. Lark kept the mechanism unloaded while the keeper showed where that smaller control met the reset linkage.

“The biggest helper,” Nib announced. “The helper with this job,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **planting**

“Er can name someone or something that does a job,” Lark explained clearly. “Help plus er makes helper; sing plus er makes singer. Read the parts, rejoin them, then ask what job the whole word describes in this sentence.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try helper, singer, player. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read helper in the prepared diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which actual lever has the reset job?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The helper can lift the arm. The player can sing.**

“Which subject can lift the arm?” Lark asked gently. “Read the job described in each sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

With the keeper, Nib tested the small lever's unloaded movement. The linkage responded where the diagram predicted. They did not reset the live cycle yet: the guide asked for a water-and-light check first. The correct control was found, and its proper moment still needed observing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write helper beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal connected the small lever to its actual work. Bigger handles no longer looked like better evidence. Outside, sunlight on the gauge and dampness on the guide created two practical problems for the next reading.

Sunlight and Raincoats

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 12

Sunlight flashed across the fixed gauge. A passing shower had dampened the guide's cover. Nib proposed moving the gauge, the shelter, and possibly the garden. Lark brought a small shade and a protective cover instead. They needed a clear reading from the same measuring point.

“A raincoat for a book,” Nib exclaimed delightedly. “And shade for a reading,” Lark added.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **helper**

“Join familiar words into sunlight, raincoat, and bookshop,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read each part, then check the whole meaning. A compound isn't just two sounds stuck together; its meaning helps us choose the useful item for our actual job.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sunlight, raincoat, bookshop. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read sunlight on the checking note,” Lark invited gently. “How can we shade the gauge while leaving its measuring point fixed?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sunlight is on the shelf. The raincoat is on the hook.**

“Which thing is on the hook?” Lark asked gently. “Where does the sunlight fall?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib shaded the gauge without moving it. Lark protected the guide and opened the correct page. The reading could now be repeated from the same place. A faint instruction described a waiting interval before the reset, but its word about sounded odd when every vowel was spoken with equal force.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write sunlight beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the fixed measuring point in its picture. A better view had changed the readability, not the evidence. The waiting instruction was the next piece of text to understand.

A Little Word Goes Quiet

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 13

Nib sounded every vowel in about as strongly as he could. The result seemed so odd that he suspected the note. Lark spoke the sentence naturally, then returned to the same printed word. Nothing had vanished from the paper; one unstressed vowel was simply quieter in speech.

“A very sleepy vowel,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A quiet one in this word,” Lark explained gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sunlight**

“In about, the first vowel is weak, /uh/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Lemon and seven have weak vowels in their unstressed parts too. We'll explicitly hear and rejoin these words. Flexible pronunciation helps us recognize a decoded word; it doesn't mean replacing it with a picture guess.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try about, lemon, seven. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Rejoin about, then reread its supplied sentence,” Lark invited gently. “What does the note ask us to observe before the reset?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The note is about the lever. I can see seven marks.**

“What is the note about?” Lark asked gently. “Does the second sentence tell us its topic or count something?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The note called for a brief observing pause before the wheel reached its marked point. Nib waited beside the keeper and watched the mark instead of tugging at the lever. The complete sequence now made sense: check flow, watch the cycle, then use the small control at the shown position.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write about beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the instruction in the right order. The keeper had the actual lever ready. The next test could now check timing without confusing a hard-to-read word with a faulty mechanism.

The Reset at Last

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 14

The keeper showed the linkage's old position beside the newly observed cycle mark. Water flowed through the cleared screen. The gauge remained fixed. Nib watched the wheel's mark approach instead of judging the moment by how long he had been waiting.

“The right helper at the right moment,” Nib murmured proudly. “And the water still flowing,” Lark added.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **about**

“Use the longer-word strategies we already know,” Lark invited warmly. “Read shelter by its chunks and sunbeam by its joined words. Check the complete operating sentence after joining each word. Today we apply prepared reading rather than introduce a surprise new spelling.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shelter, sunbeam, cupcake. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the supplied check sequence,” Lark invited gently. “Which observed position comes before the keeper moves the reset lever?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Look at the wheel mark. Then lift the small lever.**

“What must we look at before lifting the lever?” Lark asked gently. “Use the order in the passage.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

At the shown mark, the keeper moved the small control. On the next cycle, the arm released at the intended point. The water kept flowing. They watched another pass before recording that timing and flow now agreed in the test. A fresh visitor note would still check whether the instructions made sense to a new reader.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shelter beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the test result beside the earlier observations. Nib left the larger bell where it had always been. The mechanism worked in its test; the next question concerned a reader using a new page.

A Page Nobody Practiced

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 15

The keeper brought a new little visitor page about a hut and a lamp. Its scene was different from the mechanism the crew had discussed all week. Nib looked uncertain because nobody had practiced this exact passage aloud. Lark left its answer covered while you began.

“A page we have not practiced,” Nib whispered anxiously. “We can try it, and ask when we need to,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shelter**

“We can use familiar spellings on an unfamiliar page,” Lark explained warmly. “Read the words, then think about what the sentences tell us. Asking for help with a word is allowed. It doesn't change the garden's opening into a prize for reading unaided.”

“Try the fresh passage before we look at its scene,” Lark invited gently. “Where does it put the lamp?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The lamp is in the hut. The path is by the hut.**

“Is the lamp on the path or inside the hut?” Lark asked gently. “Find the sentence that tells us.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The scene materials waited on a separate dry board. After your reading, Lark opened the picture space so the lamp could be placed according to the text. If help was needed, the same words remained available. The crew used the experience to make the visitor note clearer, without inventing a reading result for anyone.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write lamp beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the actual visitor-page task. The mechanism did not have to be repaired again. With a usable note and a checked cycle, the garden was ready for its real reopening.

The Garden Opens

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 16

Neighbors came over several story days as the garden settled into its restored routine. Seeds remained seeds until they had time to grow. The keeper opened the gate to the visitor path. Nib listened to the chime, pleased that it marked the right part of an ordinary cycle.

“Not a larger bell after all,” Nib observed happily. “A garden we understand,” Lark replied with satisfaction.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **lamp**

“Read the useful words in our visitor note,” Lark invited warmly. “Join garden, helper, and planted from their prepared parts. Then keep three checks separate: water passing, timing matching, and visitors having a clear way in.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try garden, helper, planted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Use the note and our three pictures,” Lark invited gently. “Which one shows water, which shows timing, and which shows access?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The helper planted in the garden. The path is dry.**

“What is dry for the visitors?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about earlier planting instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper ran a full demonstrated cycle. Flow passed the reseated screen, the reset arm released at its marked point, and visitors used the clear path. Lark retold the two faults without calling either one a spell. The leaf stamp joined your collection, and sixteen journal chapters became The Clockwork Garden.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write helper beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The fifth book joined the library. Visitors admired the clear signs and asked about making more. An unused workshop offered a possible later project. Today, the garden's water, timing, and access were all working.